

Ἀχιλλεὺς ὁ Τατίος ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς

Achilles Tatius of Alexandria and Leucippe and Clitophon

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Period: *Ῥωμαϊκή* [Roman](#)
Dialect: *Κοινή* [Koine](#)
Domain: *Μυθιστορία* [Fiction](#)
Format: *Πεζός* [Prose](#)
Affiliation: [Sophist](#)

Achilles Tatius was a Greek author from Alexandria, Egypt, who lived during the 2nd century CE, a period of the Roman Empire. He is traditionally identified as a sophist, meaning he was trained in the rhetoric and literary culture that flourished in the Greek-speaking world at that time. Beyond this, almost no secure facts about his life are known. A later Byzantine source claims he converted to Christianity and became a bishop, but modern scholars generally consider this an unreliable tradition.

He is famous as the author of the ancient Greek novel **Leucippe and Clitophon**, which is his only surviving work. This novel follows the romantic adventures and numerous misfortunes of its central couple, featuring pirates, shipwrecks, and dramatic separations. The story is known for its elaborate, descriptive style and its use of first-person narration.

Achilles Tatius is historically important as one of the principal authors of the ancient Greek novel. **Leucippe and Clitophon** is a key example of this popular genre, which combined exciting plots with themes of love, chastity, and fortune. The work was preserved through the Byzantine period and later influenced the development of European prose fiction.

Works (1)

- τὰ κατὰ Λευκίππην καὶ Κλειτοφῶντα · [Adventures of Leucippe and Clitophon](#) · 185 passages

Other Sophist Authors

- Κλαύδιος Αἰλιανός · [Aelian of Praeneste](#) · 4 works
- Πόπλιος Αἴλιος Ἀριστείδης Θεόδωρος · [Aelius Aristides of Smyrna](#) · 3 works
- Αἴλιος Διονύσιος ὁ Ἀλικαρνασσεύς · [Aelius Dionysius of Halicarnassus](#) · 1 work
- Αἴλιος Θέων ὁ σοφιστής · [Aelius Theon the Sophist](#) · 1 work
- Ἀλκιδάμας ὁ Ἐλαεύς · [Alcidamas of Elaea](#) · 1 work
- Ἀλκίφρων ὁ Σοφιστής · [Alciphron the Sophist](#) · 1 work
- Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ τοῦ Νουμήνιου · [Alexander Son of Numenius](#) · 2 works
- Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ Ἐφέσιος · [Alexander the Ephesian Poet](#) · 1 work
- Ἀμφικράτης Ἀθηναῖος · [Amphicrates Atheniensis](#) · 1 work
- Ἀνώνυμος ὑπόμνημα εἰς Ἀφθόνιον · [Anonymous Commentary on Aphthonius](#) · 2 works

- Ἀντιφῶν ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · Antiphon of Athens · 9 works
- Ἀντιφῶν ὁ Ῥαμνοῦσιος · Antiphon of Rhamnus · 1 work